

while doing so, only move horizontally or vertically. We checked out the app in extremely glossy print, and the glare removal works very well. The app also gets rid of shadows, and is just about the best app around for adding old photos to your smartphone. The cropping is accurate, as is the perspective correction if you do not manage to capture it in a perfectly horizontal position. However, adding each photo is a time consuming process. For iOS users, bizarrely enough, the app does not let you save directly to the Camera Roll. However, you can export the image to social media apps and IM clients directly from the app. The app can actually be used to scan documents as well. To do so, turn off the glare removal feature, which is the magic wand icon on the UI. Note that the app adds a white border, as well as a note saying "PhotoScan by Google Photos". This can be cropped out though, and there is no watermark on the photo itself.

Microsoft Office Lens

Office Lens is a powerful app with OCR technology that has four modes. These are Whiteboard, Document, Photo and Business card. Only the Photo and Business card modes have any UI elements that allow the app to function in horizontal mode, which is typical for most scanner apps. The Photo mode forces you to crop in the horizontal mode as well, but fortunately, the corner guide has a handy little magnifying glass feature like most of these apps, that lets you see exactly where the corner points need to be placed. The photo gets automatically straightened after these corner points are picked. If you really want to use them, the Photos section even has a bunch of filters. Once scanned, you can export the image to the Library, or any of the Microsoft utilities including OneNote, OneDrive, Word and Powerpoint. These options are available for the Document and Whiteboard mode as well.

When it comes to Business Cards, the app does not let you automatically add the information to the contacts. Instead, you can save both the contact and the image details in OneNote. Unless you use OneNote for saving all your contact information, this can be problematic. The app is also erratic, and repeatedly gets stuck whenever it has to export any scanned

document, image or business card to other apps. Then Office Lens works really well with Word and Powerpoint. If you scan a document, the text gets automatically added to word with the formatting preserved. If you scan a whiteboard or sketches on a notepad for Powerpoint, they get converted into line graphics that can be directly manipulated within Powerpoint. Apart from all of these, Microsoft Lens also allows you to annotate scans, as well as save them to a PDF format.

TapScanner

TapScanner has fewer modes than the other apps here, and only supports QR, Document and Photos. The Document mode though has been designed to scan a lot of documents very quickly and in rapid succession. There are a number of modes that automatically clean up the capture, which is sliders to adjust the brightness and contrast. This is great for scanning documents in a range of lighting conditions. However, the best modes require you to pay, and the default ones are not very good.

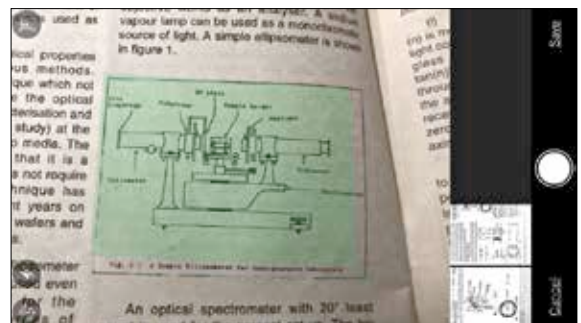
TapScanner has extensive features for organising your scans within the app. You can sort documents into folders, and give them tags. The Pro version lets users sign documents digitally, as well as capture text using OCR technology. All of these features work well, but are not the best. For verifying the OCR, there is a compare mode that lets you see the original scan side by side to the captured text. There are some problems with formatting since the line breaks are preserved.

There are some extra features in TapScanner not found in the other apps. It lets you specify the quality, and by extension the size of the PDFs created from the scanned documents. You can also export the images as PNG files, and there are quality options for this as well. The pro subscription with unlimited access to all the good features costs ₹4,199 a year.

Evernote

When it comes to the clarity of "scanned" documents using a smartphone app,

Evernote is easily the best. You do not even have to press the trigger to scan the photo, just point the camera at the document, photo or business card and it is automatically scanned. Instead of giving the user options of what the object of the scanning is, such as business card, whiteboard, photo or document, Evernote automatically recognises the type of object and intelligently uses the information. For example if you point the phone towards a business card, then the contact information is automatically obtained, and the image is stored in a folder called Business Cards. When scanning a document, all the small details of the print are preserved, the threshold for black and white never messes up by adding random noise, the shadows and creases are removed, and handwritten notes just look good. A weak point is that the camera scanning features are not as expansive as the other apps. Once again, in terms of clarity, Evernote is the best, and the free version works in this sense unlike TapScanner.



Scanning a document with Evernote

Evernote is the best app that allows you to sync digital and physical notes across platforms. As the information is available across platforms, Evernote can just be a bin for all the information that you need to access. You can just put it in Evernote and forget about it, then search for it when you need it. There are really innovative ways to use these features, from keeping track of winning in game items, to takeout menus of restaurants, to railway timetables, and more. The Evernote app works as well at a distance as it does close up, and it is one of the few scanning apps that does that.

MOBILE BROWSERS

You are probably using Chrome, which is installed by default on most phones any-